

अथ प्रथमचरितम्

महाकालीध्यानम्

खड्गं चक्रगदेषुचापपरिधान् शूलं भुशुण्डीं शिरः
शङ्खं सन्दधतीं करैस्त्रिनयनां सर्वाङ्गभूषावृताम् ।
यां हन्तुं मधुकैटभौ जलजभूस्तुष्टाव सुप्ते हरौ
नीलाश्मद्युतिमास्यपाददशकां सेवे महाकालिकाम् ॥

MEDITATION OF MAHĀKĀLĪ

I resort to Mahākālī, who has ten faces, ten legs and holds in her hands the sword, disc, mace, arrows, bow, club, spear, missile, human head and conch, who is three-eyed, adorned with ornaments on all her limbs, and luminous like a blue jewel, and whom Brahmā extolled in order to destroy Madhu and Kaiṭabha, when Viṣṇu was in (mystic) sleep.

ॐ नमश्चण्डिकायै

ॐ ऐं मार्कण्डेय उवाच ॥ १ ॥

सावर्णिः सूर्यतनयो यो मनुः कथ्यतेऽष्टमः ।
निशामय तदुत्पत्तिं विस्तराद्भदतो मम ॥ २ ॥

महामायानुभावेन यथा मन्वन्तराधिपः ।
स बभूव महाभागः सावर्णिस्तनयो रवेः ॥ ३ ॥

1-3. Mārkaṇḍeya said (to his disciple, Krasuṣṭuki Bhāguri): Sāvarni¹, son of Sūrya, is called the eighth Manu². Listen, while I describe in detail about his birth, how Sāvarni, illustrious son of Sūrya, became the lord of the (eighth) Manvantara by the grace of Mahāmāyā³.

1. Sāvarni was so called because he was the son of Savarnā, Sūrya's wife. He became King Suratha in the second (Svārociṣa) manvantara.

2. One cycle of creation is divided into fourteen manvantaras. The period ruled over by one Manu is called a Manvantara. There are therefore fourteen Manus as follows: Svāyambhuva, Swarociṣa, Uttama, Tāmasa, Raivata, Cākṣuṣa; Vaivasvata, Sāvarni, Dakṣa-sāvarni, Brahma-sāvarni, Dharma-sāvarni, Rudra-sāvarni, Deva-sāvarni, and Indra-sāvarni.

3. One of the names of the Divine Mother.

स्वरोचिषेऽन्तरे पूर्वं चैत्रवंशसमुद्भवः ।
 सुरथो नाम राजाभूत्समस्ते क्षितिमण्डले ॥ ४ ॥
 तस्य पालयतः सम्यक् प्रजाः पुत्रानिवौरसान् ।
 बभूवुः शत्रवो भूपाः कोलाविध्वंसिनस्तदा ॥ ५ ॥
 तस्य तैरभवद्युद्धमतिप्रबलदण्डिनः ।
 न्यूनैरपि स तैर्युद्धे कोलाविध्वंसिभिर्जितः ॥ ६ ॥
 ततः स्वपुरमायातो निजदेशाधिपोऽभवत् ।
 आक्रान्तः स महाभागस्तैस्तदा प्रबलारिभिः ॥ ७ ॥

4-5. In former times there was a king named Suratha, born of the Caitra⁴ dynasty, ruling over the whole world in the period of Svarociṣa. He protected his subjects duly like his own children. At that time the kings, who were the destroyers of the Kolās⁵, became his enemies.

6-7. He, the wielder of powerful weapons, fought a battle with the destroyers of Kolās, but was defeated by them though they were a small force. Then he returned to his own city, and ruled over his own country. Then that illustrious king was attacked by those powerful enemies.

4. Caitra is said to be the first son of Svarociṣa.

5. The word Kolāvidhvamsinah is variously explained by the commentators. Pargiter explains the word "enemies in alliance with Kolās. Kolās may refer to the aboriginal race of Kolās, whose descendents are even now living in some parts of India."

अमात्यैर्बलिभिर्दुष्टैर्दुर्बलस्य दुरात्मभिः ।

कोशो बलं चापहृतं तत्रापि स्वपुरे ततः ॥ ८ ॥

ततो मृगयाव्याजेन हृतस्वाम्यः स भूपतिः ।

एकाकी हयमारुह्य जगाम गहनं वनम् ॥ ९ ॥

स तत्राश्रममद्राक्षीद्वृजवर्यस्य मेधसः ।

प्रशान्तः श्वापदाकीर्णं मुनिशिष्योपशोभितम् ॥ १० ॥

तस्थौ कञ्चित्स कालं च मुनिना तेन सत्कृतः ।

इतश्चेतश्च विचरंस्तस्मिन् मुनिवराश्रमे ॥ ११ ॥

सोऽचिन्तयत्तदा तत्र ममत्वाकृष्टमानसः ॥ १२ ॥

8-9. Even in his own city, the king, (now) bereft of strength, was robbed of his treasury and army by his own powerful, vicious and evil-disposed ministers. Thereafter, deprived of his sovereignty, the king left alone on horse-back for a dense forest, under the pretext of hunting.

10-11. He saw there the hermitage of Medhas—the supreme among the twice-born—inhabited by wild animals which were peaceful, and graced by the disciples of the sage. Entertained by the sage, Suratha spent some time moving about in the hermitage of the great sage.

12-16. There then overcome with attachment, he fell into the thought, 'I do not know whether the

मत्पूर्वैः पालितं पूर्वं मया हीनं पुरं हि तत् ।
 मद्भृत्यैस्तैरसद्वृत्तैर्धर्मतः पाल्यते न वा ॥ १३ ॥
 न जाने स प्रधानो मे शूरो हस्ती सदा मदः ।
 मम वैरिवशं यातः कान् भोगानुपलप्स्यते ॥ १४ ॥
 ये ममानुगता नित्यं प्रसादधनभोजनैः ।
 अनुवृत्तिं ध्रुवं तेऽद्य कुर्वन्त्यन्यमहीभृताम् ॥ १५ ॥
 असम्यग्व्ययशीलैस्तैः कुर्वद्भिः सततं व्ययम् ।
 सञ्चितः सोऽतिदुःखेन क्षयं कोशो गमिष्यति ॥ १६ ॥
 एतच्चान्यच्च सततं चिन्तयामास पार्थिवः ।
 तत्र विप्राश्रमाभ्याशे वैश्यमेकं ददर्श सः ॥ १७ ॥

capital (which was) well guarded by my ancestors and recently deserted by me is being guarded righteously or not by my servants of evil conduct. I do not know what enjoyments my chief elephant, heroic and always elated, and now fallen into the hands of my foes, will get. Those who were my constant followers and received favour, riches and food from me, now certainly pay homage to other kings. The treasure which I gathered with great care will be squandered by those constant spendthrifts, who are addicted to improper expenditures.' The king was continually thinking of these and other things.

17-19. Near the hermitage of the Brāhmaṇa he saw a merchant, and asked him: Ho! Who are you?

स पृष्टस्तेन कस्त्वं भो हेतुश्चागमनेऽत्र कः ।
 सशोक इव कस्मात्त्वं दुर्मना इव लक्ष्यसे ॥ १८ ॥
 इत्याकर्ण्य वचस्तस्य भूपतेः प्रणयोदितम् ।
 प्रत्युवाच स तं वैश्यः प्रश्रयावनतो नृपम् ॥ १९ ॥
 वैश्य उवाच ॥ २० ॥

समाधिर्नाम वैश्योऽहमुत्पन्नो धनिनां कुले ।
 पुत्रदारैर्निरस्तश्च धनलोभादसाधुभिः ॥ २१ ॥
 विहीनश्च धनैर्दारैः पुत्रैरादाय मे धनम् ।
 वनमभ्यागतो दुःखी निरस्तश्चाप्तबन्धुभिः ॥ २२ ॥

What is the reason for your coming here? Wherefore do you appear as if afflicted with grief and depressed in mind? Hearing this speech of the king, uttered in a friendly spirit, the merchant, bowed respectfully and replied to the king.

20-25. The merchant said: I am a merchant named Samādhī, born in a wealthy family. I have been cast out by my sons and wife, who are wicked through greed of wealth. My wife and sons have misappropriated my riches, and made me devoid of wealth. Cast out by my trusted kinsmen, I have come to the forest grief-stricken. Dwelling here, I do not know anything as regards good or bad of my sons, kinsmen and wife. At present is welfare or ill-luck

सोऽहं न वेद्मि पुत्राणां कुशलाकुशलात्मिकाम् ।
 प्रवृत्तिं स्वजनानां च दाराणां चात्र संस्थितः ॥ २३ ॥
 किं नु तेषां गृहे क्षेममक्षेमं किं नु साम्प्रतम् ॥ २४ ॥
 कथं ते किं नु सदृत्ता दुर्वृत्ताः किं नु मे सुताः ॥ २५ ॥
 राजोवाच ॥ २६ ॥
 यैर्निरस्तो भवौलुब्धैः पुत्रदारादिभिर्धनैः ॥ २७ ॥
 तेषु किं भवतः स्निहमनुवध्नाति मानसम् ॥ २८ ॥
 वैश्य उवाच ॥ २९ ॥

एवमेतद्यथा ग्राह भवानस्मद्गतं वचः ।
 किं करोमि न वध्नाति मम निष्ठुरतां मनः ॥ ३० ॥
 यैः सन्त्यज्य पितृस्नेहं धनलुब्धैर्निराकृतः ।
 पतिः स्वजनहार्दं च हार्दितेष्वेव मे मनः ॥ ३१ ॥

theirs at home? How are they? Are my sons living good or evil lives?

26-28. The king said: Why is your mind affectionately attached to those covetous folk, your sons, wife and others, who have deprived you of your wealth?

29-34. The merchant said: This very thought has occurred to me, just as you have uttered it. What can I do? My mind does not become hard; it bears

किमेतन्नामिजानामि जानन्नपि महामते ।

यत्प्रेमप्रवर्णं चित्तं विगुणेष्वपि बन्धुषु ॥ ३२ ॥

तेषां कृते मे निःश्वासो दौर्मनस्यं च जायते ॥ ३३ ॥

करोमि किं यन्न मनस्तेष्वप्रीतिषु निष्ठुरम् ॥ ३४ ॥

मार्कण्डेय उवाच ॥ ३५ ॥

ततस्तौ सहितौ विप्र तं मुनिं समुपस्थितौ ॥ ३६ ॥

समाधिर्नाम वैश्योऽसौ स च पार्थिवसत्तमः ॥ ३७ ॥

कृत्वा तु तौ यथान्यायं यथार्हं तेन संविदम् ।

उपविष्टौ कथाः काश्चिच्चक्रतुर्वैश्यपार्थिवौ ॥ ३८ ॥

deep affection to those very persons who have driven me out in their greed for wealth, abandoning love for a father and attachment to one's master and kinsmen. I do not comprehend although, I know it, O noble-hearted king, how it is that the mind is prone to love even towards worthless kinsmen. On account of them I heave heavy sighs and feel dejected. What can I do since my mind does not become hard towards those unloving ones ?

35-38. Mārkaṇḍeya said : Then O Brāhmaṇa, the merchant Samādhī and the noble king together approached the sage (Medhas); and after observing the

राजोवाच ॥ ३९ ॥

भगवंस्त्वामहं प्रष्टुमिच्छाम्येकं वदस्व तत् ॥ ४० ॥

दुःखाय यन्मे मनसः स्वचित्तायत्ततां विना ॥ ४१ ॥

ममत्वं गतराज्यस्य राज्याङ्गेष्वखिलेष्वपि ।

जानतोऽपि यथाज्ञस्य किमेतन्मुनिसत्तम ॥ ४२ ॥

अयं च निकृतः पुत्रैर्दारैर्भृत्यैस्तथोज्झितः ।

स्वजनेन च सन्त्यक्तस्तेषु हार्दी तथाप्यति ॥ ४३ ॥

एवमेष तथाहं च द्वावप्यत्यन्तदुःखितौ ।

दृष्टदोषेऽपि विषये ममत्वाकृष्टमानसौ ॥ ४४ ॥

etiquette worthy of him and as was proper, they sat down and conversed (with him) on some topics.

39-45. The king said: Sir, I wish to ask you one thing. Be pleased to reply to it. Without the control of my intellect, my mind is afflicted with sorrow. Though I have lost the kingdom, like an ignorant man—though I know it—I have an attachment to all the paraphernalia of my kingdom. How is this, O best of sages? And this merchant has been disowned by his children, wife and servants, and forsaken by his own people; still he is inordinately affectionate towards them. Thus both he and I, drawn by attachment towards objects whose defects we do know, are

तत्केनैतन्महाभाग यन्मोहो ज्ञानिनोरपि ।
ममास्य च भवत्येषा विवेकान्धस्य मूढता ॥ ४५ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ४६ ॥

ज्ञानमस्ति समस्तस्य जन्तोर्विषयगोचरे ।
विषयाश्च महाभाग यान्ति चैवं पृथक्पृथक् ॥ ४७ ॥

दिवान्धाः प्राणिनः केचिद्रात्रावन्धास्तथापरे ।
केचिदिवा तथा रात्रौ प्राणिनस्तुल्यदृष्टयः ॥ ४८ ॥

ज्ञानिनो मनुजाः सत्यं किन्तु ते न हि केवलम् ।
यतो हि ज्ञानिनः सर्वे पशुपक्षिमृगादयः ॥ ४९ ॥

exceedingly unhappy. How this happens, then, sir, that though we are aware of it, this delusion comes? This delusion besets me as well as him, blinded as we are in respect of discrimination.⁶

46-49. The Rṣi said: Sir, every being has the knowledge of objects perceivable by the senses. An object of sense reaches it in various ways. Some beings are blind by day, and others are blind by night, Some beings have equal sight both by day and night. Human beings are certainly endowed with knowledge, but they are not the only beings (to be so endowed),

6. It is by the light of discrimination we know the proper nature of things real and unreal.

ज्ञानं च तन्मनुष्याणां यत्तेषां मृगपक्षिणाम् ।
मनुष्याणां च यत्तेषां तुल्यमन्यत्तथोभयोः ॥ ५० ॥

ज्ञानेऽपि सति पश्यैतान् पतगाञ्छावचञ्चुषु ।
कणमोक्षादृतान् मोहात्पीड्यमानानपि क्षुधा ॥ ५१ ॥

मानुषा मनुजव्याघ्र सामिलाषाः सुतान् प्रति ।
लोभात् प्रत्युपकाराय नन्वेतान् किं न पश्यसि ॥ ५२ ॥

तथापि ममतावर्ते मोहगर्ते निपातिताः ।
महामायाप्रभावेण संसारस्थितिकारिणा ॥ ५३ ॥

for cattle, birds, animals and other creatures also cognize (objects of senses).

50-58. The knowledge that men have, birds and beasts too have; and what they have, men also possess; and the rest (like eating and sleeping) is common to both of them. Look at these birds, which though they possess knowledge, and are themselves distressed by hunger are yet, because of the delusion, engaged in dropping grains into the beaks of their young ones. Human beings are, O Tiger among men, attached to their children because of greed for return help. Do you not see this? Even so men are hurled into the whirlpool of attachment, the pit of delusion, through the power of Mahāmāyā (the Great Illusion), who makes the existence of the world possible.

तन्नात्र विस्मयः कार्यो योगनिद्रा जगत्पतेः ।
 महामाया हरेश्चैषा तया सम्मोह्यते जगत् ॥ ५४ ॥
 ज्ञानिनामपि चेतांसि देवी भगवती हि सा ।
 बलादाकृष्य मोहाय महामाया प्रयच्छति ॥ ५५ ॥
 तया विमृज्यते विश्वं जगदेतच्चराचरम् ।
 सैषा प्रसन्ना वरदा नृणां भवति मुक्तये ॥ ५६ ॥
 सा विद्या परमा मुक्तेर्हेतुभूता सनातनी ॥ ५७ ॥
 संसारबन्धहेतुश्च सैव सर्वेश्वरेश्वरी ॥ ५८ ॥

राजोवाच ॥ ५९ ॥

Marvel not at this. This Mahāmāyā is the Yoganidrā,⁷ of Viṣṇu, the lord of the world. It is by her the world is deluded. Verily she, the Bhagavatī, Mahāmāyā forcibly drawing the minds of even the wise, throws them into delusion. She creates this entire universe, both moving and unmoving. It is she who, when propitious, becomes a boon-giver to human beings for their final liberation. She is the supreme knowledge, the cause of final liberation, and eternal; she is the cause of the bondage of transmigration and the sovereign over all lords.

59-62. The king said: Venerable sir, who is that Devī whom you call Mahāmāyā? How did she come

7. Yoga-nidrā is the tāmasic power of Hari.

भगवन् का हि सा देवी महामायेति यां भवान् ।
ब्रवीति कथमुत्पन्ना सा कर्मास्याश्च किं द्विज ॥ ६० ॥

यत्प्रभावा च सा देवी यत्स्वरूपा यदुद्भवा ॥ ६१ ॥

तत्सर्वं श्रोतुमिच्छामि त्वत्तो ब्रह्मविदां वर ॥ ६२ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ६३ ॥

नित्यैव सा जगन्मूर्तिस्तया सर्वमिदं ततम् ॥ ६४ ॥

तथापि तत्समुत्पत्तिर्वहुधा श्रूयतां मम ॥ ६५ ॥

देवानां कार्यसिद्धयर्थमाविर्भवति सा यदा ।

उत्पन्नेति तदा लोके सा नित्याप्यभिधीयते ॥ ६६ ॥

into being, and what is her sphere of action, O Brāhmaṇa? What constitutes her nature? What is her form? Wherefrom did she originate? All that I wish to hear from you, O you supreme among the knowers of Brahman.

63-71. The Ṛṣi said: She is eternal, embodied as the universe. By her all this is pervaded. Nevertheless she incarnates in manifold ways; hear it from me. When she manifests herself in order to accomplish the purposes of the devas, she is said to be born in the world, though she is eternal. At the end of a kalpa when the universe was one ocean (with the waters

योगनिद्रां यदा विष्णुर्जगत्येकार्णवीकृते ।

आस्तीर्य शेषमभजत् कल्पान्ते भगवान् प्रभुः ॥ ६७ ॥

तदा द्वावसुरौ घोरौ विख्यातौ मधुकैटभौ ।

विष्णुकर्णमलोद्भूतौ हन्तुं ब्रह्माणमुद्यतौ ॥ ६८ ॥

स नाभिकमले विष्णोः स्थितो ब्रह्मा प्रजापतिः ।

दृष्ट्वा तावसुरौ चोग्रौ प्रसुप्तं च जनार्दनम् ॥ ६९ ॥

तुष्ट्वा योगनिद्रां तामेकाग्रहृदयः स्थितः ।

विवोधनार्थाय हरेर्हरिनेत्रकृतालयाम् ॥ ७० ॥

of the deluge)⁸ and the adorable Lord Viṣṇu stretched out on S'eṣa⁹ and took to mystic slumber, two terrible asuras, the well-known Madhu and Kaiṭabha, sprung into being from the dirt of Viṣṇu's ears, sought to slay Brahmā; Brahmā, the father of beings, was sitting in the lotus that (came out) from Viṣṇu's navel. Seeing these two fierce asuras and Janārdana asleep, and with a view to awaken Hari, (Brahmā) with concentrated mind extolled Yoganidrā, dwelling in Hari's eyes. The resplendent Lord Brahmā extolled the in-

8. Pralaya or deluge overtakes the world at the end of an aeon, when rain and rising water submerge the whole earth. The unified undifferentiated water to which everything is reduced signifies primordial cause.

9. Ananta, lord of serpents who supports the earth, is the Lord's Couch.

विश्वेश्वरीं जगद्धात्रीं स्थितिसंहारकारिणीम् ।
निद्रां भगवतीं विष्णोरतुलां तेजसः प्रभुः ॥ ७१ ॥

ब्रह्मोवाच ॥ ७२ ॥

त्वं स्वाहा त्वं स्वधा त्वं हि वषट्कारः स्वरात्मिका ।
सुधा त्वमक्षरे नित्ये त्रिधामात्रात्मिका स्थिता ॥ ७३ ॥

अर्धमात्रा स्थिता नित्या यानुच्चार्याविशेषतः ।
त्वमेव सा त्वं सावित्री त्वं देवजननी परा ॥ ७४ ॥

comparable Goddess of Viṣṇu, Yoganidrā, the queen of cosmos, the supporter of the worlds, the cause of the sustentation and dissolution alike (of the universe).

72-74. Brahmā said: 'You are Svāhā¹⁰ and Svadhā¹¹. You are verily the Vaṣaṭkāra¹² and embodiment of svara¹³. You are the nector¹⁴. O eternal and imperishable One, You are the embodiment of the

10. The propitiatory Mantra of the devas uttered when an oblation is poured in the fire for them.

11. The propitiatory mantra of the manes (Pitṛs) uttered when offerings are made in ceremonies in honour of departed ancestors.

12. Vaṣaṭkāra in the text signifies Yajña, Vedic sacrifice.

13. Devi is herself the sacrifice and the heaven to be attained through the performance.

14. Sudhā, the food of the devas, signifies immortality.

त्वयैतद्धार्यते विश्वं त्वयैतत् सृज्यते जगत् ।
त्वयैतत् पाल्यते देवि त्वमत्स्यन्ते च सर्वदा ॥ ७५ ॥

विसृष्टौ सृष्टिरूपा त्वं स्थितिरूपा च पालने ।
तथा संहतिरूपान्ते जगतोऽस्य जगन्मये ॥ ७६ ॥

महाविद्या महामाया महामेधा महास्मृतिः ।
महामोहा च भवती महादेवी महासुरी ॥ ७७ ॥

threefold *mātrā*¹⁵. You are half a *mātrā*, though eternal. You are verily that which cannot be uttered specifically. You are *Sāvitṛī*¹⁶ and the supreme Mother of the devas.

75-77. 'By you this universe is borne, by you this world is created. By you it is protected, O Devī; and you always consume it at the end. O you who are (always) of the form of the whole world, at the time of creation you are of the form of the creative force, at the time of sustentation you are of the form of the protective power, and at the time of the dissolution of the world, you are of the form of the destructive power. You are the supreme knowledge as well as the great nescience, the great intellect and contemplation,

15. *Omkāra*, made up of *a u* and *m*.

16. The famous *Sāvitṛī* hymn which occurs in *R̥gveda*.

प्रकृतिस्त्वं च सर्वस्य गुणत्रयविभाषिणी ।
 कालरात्रिर्महारात्रिर्मोहरात्रिश्च दारुणा ॥ ७८ ॥
 त्वं श्रीस्त्वमीश्वरी त्वं हीस्त्वं बुद्धिबोधलक्षणा ।
 लज्जा पुष्टिस्तथा तुष्टिस्त्वं शान्तिः क्षान्तिरेव च ॥ ७९ ॥
 खड्गिनी शूलिनी घोरा गदिनी चक्रिणी तथा ।
 शङ्खिनी चापिनी बाणभुशुण्डीपरिघायुधा ॥ ८० ॥
 सौम्या सौम्यतराशेषसौम्येभ्यस्त्वतिसुन्दरी ।
 परापराणां परमा त्वमेव परमेश्वरी ॥ ८१ ॥

as also the great delusion, the great devī as also indeed the great asurī¹⁷.

78-81. 'You are the primordial cause of everything, bringing into force the three qualities¹⁸. You are the dark night of periodic dissolution. You are the great night of final dissolution, and the terrible night of delusion. You are the goddess of good fortune, the ruler, modesty, intelligence characterised by knowledge, bashfulness, nourishment, contentment, tranquillity and forbearance. Armed with sword, spear, club, discus, conch, bow, arrows, slings and iron mace,

17. All powers of good and evil belong to her. Power of good is Hers, as much as powers of evil.

18. Sattva, Rajas and Tamas of which all things are composed.

यच्च किञ्चित्कचिद्वस्तु सदसद्राखिलात्मिके ।

तस्य सर्वस्य या शक्तिः सा त्वं किं स्तूयसे मया ॥८२॥

यया त्वया जगत्स्रष्टा जगत्पातात्ति यो जगत् ।

सोपि निद्रावशं नीतः कस्त्वां स्तोतुमिहेश्वरः ॥ ८३ ॥

विष्णुः शरीरग्रहणमहमीशान एव च ।

कारितास्ते यतोऽतस्त्वां कः स्तोतुं शक्तिमान् भवेत् ॥८४॥

सा त्वमित्थं प्रभावैः स्वैरुदारैर्देवि संस्तुता ।

मोहयैतौ दुराधर्षावसुरौ मधुकैटभौ ॥ ८५ ॥

you are terrible (and at the same time) you are pleasing, yea more pleasing than all the pleasing things and exceedingly beautiful¹⁹. You are indeed the supreme *Īsvarī*, beyond the high and low.

82-87. 'And whatever or wherever a thing exists, conscient (real) or non-conscient (unreal), whatever power all that possesses is yourself. O you who are the soul of everything, how can I extol you (more than this)? By you, even he who creates, sustains and devours the world, is put to sleep. Who is here capable of extolling you? Who is capable of praising you, who have made all of us—*Viṣṇu*, myself and

19. She is compassionate to those who surrender to her, but terrible to those who disobey and go against her.

प्रबोधं च जगत्स्वामी नीयतामच्युतो लघु ॥ ८६ ॥

बोधश्च क्रियतामस्य हन्तुमेतौ महासुरौ ॥ ८७ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ८८ ॥

एवं स्तुता तदा देवी तामसी तत्र वेधसा ।

विष्णोः प्रबोधनार्थाय निहन्तुं मधुकैटभौ ॥ ८९ ॥

नेत्रास्यनासिकाबाहुहृदयेभ्यस्तथोऽसः ।

निर्गम्य दर्शने तस्थौ ब्रह्मणोऽव्यक्तजन्मनः ॥ ९० ॥

उत्तस्थौ च जगन्नाथस्तया मुक्तो जनार्दनः ।

एकार्णवेऽहिश्यनात्ततः स ददृशे च तौ ॥ ९१ ॥

S'iva—take our embodied forms. O Devī, being lauded thus, bewitch these two unassailable asuras Madhu and Kaitābha with your superior powers. Let Viṣṇu, the master of the world, be quickly awakened from sleep and rouse up his nature to slay these two great asuras'.

88-95. The Ṛṣi said: There, the Devī of delusion²⁰ extolled thus by Brahmā, the creator, in order to awaken Viṣṇu for the destruction of Madhu and

20. According to the three guṇas of Nature, Mahamāyā takes three forms, Mahākālī, Mahālakshmī, and Mahāśarasvatī, being Her tāmasika, rājasika, and sāttvika forms.

मधुकैटभौ दुरात्मानावतिवीर्यपराक्रमौ ।

क्रोधरक्तेक्षणावत्तुं ब्रह्माणं जनितोद्यमौ ॥ ९२ ॥

समुत्थाय ततस्ताभ्यां युयुधे भगवान् हरिः ।

पञ्चवर्षसहस्राणि बाहुप्रहरणो विभुः ॥ ९३ ॥

तावप्यतिबलोन्मत्तौ महामायाविमोहितौ ॥ ९४ ॥

उक्तवन्तौ वरोऽस्मत्तो व्रियतामिति केशवम् ॥ ९५ ॥

श्रीभगवानुवाच ॥ ९६ ॥

भवेतामद्य मे तुष्टौ मम वध्यावुभावपि ॥ ९७ ॥

Kaiṭabha, drew herself out from His eyes, mouth, nostrils, arms, heart and breast, and appeared in the sight of Brahmā of inscrutable birth. Janārdana, lord of the universe, quitted by her, rose up from his couch on the universal ocean, and saw those two evil (asuras), Madhu and Kaiṭabha, of exceeding heroism and power, with eyes red in anger, endeavouring to devour Brahmā. Thereupon the all-pervading Bhagavān Viṣṇu got up and fought with asuras for five thousand years, using his own arms as weapons. And they, frenzied with their exceeding power, and deluded by Mahāmāyā, exclaimed to Viṣṇu, 'Ask a boon from us'.

96-98. Bhagavān (Viṣṇu) said: If you are satisfied with me, you must both be slain by me now.

किमन्येन वरेणात्र एतावद्धि वृतं मम ॥ ९८ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ९९ ॥

वञ्चिताभ्यामिति तदा सर्वमापोमयं जगत् ।

विलोक्य ताभ्यां गदितो भगवान् कमलेक्षणः ॥ १०० ॥

आवां जहि न यत्रोर्वी सलिलेन परिप्लुता ॥ १०१ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १०२ ॥

तथेत्युक्त्वा भगवता शङ्खचक्रगदाभृता ।

कृत्वा चक्रेण वै छिन्ने जघने शिरसी तयोः ॥ १०३ ॥

What need is there of any other boon here? My choice is this much indeed.

99-101. The Ṛṣi said: Those two (asuras), thus bewitched (by Mahāmāyā), gazing then at the entire world turned into water, told Bhagavān, the lotus-eyed One, 'Slay us at the spot where the earth is not flooded with water.'

102-104. The Ṛṣi said: Saying, 'Be it so', Bhagavān (Viṣṇu), the great wielder of conch, discus and club, took them on his loins²¹ and there severed

21. As the whole Universe was flooded, the demons thought the Lord would not be able to find a waterless spot to kill them; as however, the Deluge-water had not come up to the loins of the Lord, he took them up there and killed them.

एवमेषा समुत्पन्ना ब्रह्मणा संस्तुता स्वयम् ।
प्रभावस्य देव्यास्तु भूयः शृणु वदामि ते ॥ १०४ ॥

ॐ श्रीमार्कण्डेयपुराणे सावर्णिके मन्वन्तरे देवीमाहात्म्ये
मधुकैटभवधो नाम प्रथमोऽध्यायः ॥ १ ॥

their heads with his discus. Thus she (Mahāmāyā) herself appeared when praised by Brahmā. Now listen again of the glory of this Devī. I tell you.

Here ends the first chapter called, 'The slaying
of Madhu and Kaitabha' of Devīmāhātmya
in Markandeyapurāṇa, during the
period of Sāvarni, the Manu.

